verse, ‘Even if terrible fate came in many forms, I will face it.’ He continued valiantly, ‘I will not fear or weary.’

> My mind,
> my body,
> my happiness,
> my conviction,
> my wife, my children,
> my wealth—
> even if all were to flounder,
> I shall not be cowed down.
> Even if Death should come,
> I shall stamp upon and vanquish him.

Composing defiant verses was one thing, facing legal requirements quite another. Following the court notice, in the first week of May 1912, Meenakshi was writing to Srivaikundam T.R. Mahadeva Iyer—lawyer and Swadeshi activist—asking him for copies of VOC’s account in the company, his letters of resignation as assistant secretary, and later as superintendent (it is not clear why, on more than one occasion, this post is referred to as such rather than as agent), and of certain resolutions passed in various meetings of the board of directors.[73] Evidently, Meenakshi was gathering the documentation to contest the notice. Writing to an unidentified addressee—a lawyer—she seems to have appended a notice from the Tirunelveli district court.[74] In a letter written on 9 June, she recorded an important fact: in June 1908, when VOC had resigned his position in the company, P.L. Vengu Aiyar, accompanied by some other directors of the company, had promised to waive all the dues owed by VOC. This verbal assurance had not been given written confirmation. VOC did not become aware of this until the notice came from the district court during the liquidation. Meenakshi blamed fate for this new adversity.[75] This was not the only promise that SSNCo’s officers did not keep. In October 1908, V. Sankaraiah, the head accountant, had reassured VOC that even if his appeal to the Privy Council were to fail, ‘we will try our utmost to